The matter did not end here. In compliance with the apex court's time-bound directions we now prepared our report, based on the discussions of the group I had convened. I then sent it to the Ministry of Home Affairs to forward the same to the Supreme Court through the standing legal counsel as is the practice. Despite many reminders, we did not get any response from the home secretary's office. When we were almost reaching the deadline, and non-submission could have led to contempt of court, I asked my office to approach the legal counsel of the ministry. The latter refused outright, saying that there were no instructions from the head office. We were then left with no choice but to submit our report directly to the registrar's office of the Supreme Court. This was not taken in right perspective. As was the message conveyed through my colleagues in the bureau.

I further saw, firsthand, as I was present in one of the meetings, the manner in which a small group of key officials led by none other than Shivraj Patil, the then Union home minister (later compelled to resign as a consequence of the Mumbai terror war), arbitrarily amending the wordings of many a section meticulously drafted in the Model Police Act, 2006 (see www.bprd.gov.in for details), by a select team chosen from a cross-section of professional experts, duly appointed after the minister's approval. Since I too (by virtue of being the DG, BPRD) was a member of this team, I was aware of the tremendous effort that had been put in before each word and each concept was finalized.

It was becoming more than evident that, because of a few self-perpetuating 'controllers', police reforms in the country had remained paralysed and will remain so, barring cosmetic changes, which will be made only to assuage public anger. A paradigm shift in police reforms will take place only when the people at the helm would truly want the 'rule of law' in letter and in spirit.

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For my part, I was clear in my mind that I was now not going to be subordinated by this team of saboteurs and be directed by persons who were committed only to enslaving a system. What direction and leadership would such persons provide except to create pygmies and stifle initiative and crush morale? I did not want to be a part of such dubious 'history'.

When I was in service, I had all along worked with an innate sense of *commitment to the service* and never to any individual howsoever highly placed, which is why some of my seniors wanted me out of sight and, if possible, out of the system. At times, I had been just 'parked' in offices that had either no work or no expectation from work. Or else I was sent to jails or training schools (perceived wrongly by them as 'backyard postings') as against direct field assignments. Many of my seniors kept on denying me opportunities to express my creativity, which would enable me to directly communicate with the people and to put in place much needed participative police initiatives and reforms. But since such creativity was threatening to a static system, I had to be kept away. Therefore, I was given what many others could dare to reject due their proximity to the right spheres of 'influence'.

The fact that I continued to reinvent myself in whatever office I was placed in and came up with innovative ideas and practical solutions for getting rid of various deficiencies angered my detractors even more. In their view, whatever I did was just to hog publicity and leave them behind. For me, involving the media was a means of making the people stakeholders not only in the welfare and development of society but also in the safety and security of the country. And we know that the media is no one's friend. If it was reporting me frequently it was because it had something new to highlight.

This was exactly what happened during my last assignment. I was appointed the director general of the BPRD, New Delhi. The BPRD is the only Central agency of the Government of India to critically look at police research at a national level. However, this bureau has been kept weak and virtually